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(54) **FLOORING EDGE TOOLS**

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15, 2020.

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A47G 27/04 (2006.01)

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(52) **U.S. Cl.**

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(2013.01); **E04F 2290/04** (2013.01)

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27/0487; **E04F 15/02027**; **E04F 15/02155**;
E04F 2290/04

See application file for complete search history.

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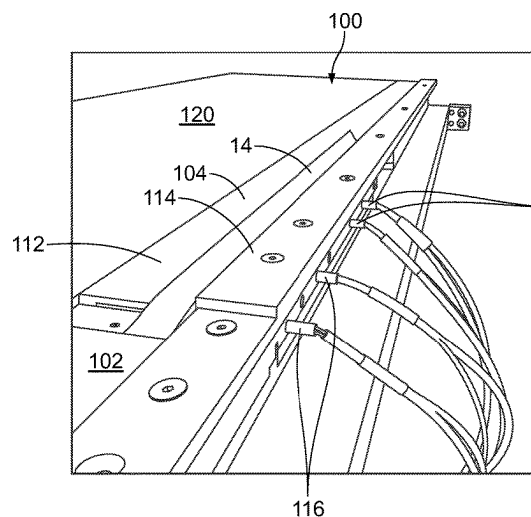
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Laura A. Labeots

(57)

ABSTRACT

A hand-held or table-mounted tool for adhering a flooring
edge finish to a flooring edge. The hand-held tool includes
a main body, which can include a handle, a base, and a
bi-level soleplate, which is heated during application to
adhere a flooring edge finish to a flooring edge. The soleplate
of the tool can be made of polymer, carbon, metal, ceramic,
glass, or a mixture thereof.

21 Claims, 9 Drawing Sheets



130

132

Feed a flooring edge finish into a feed section of a table-mounted flooring edge
tool.

134

Feed the flooring along the feed section.

136

Use an attachment section of a table-mounted flooring edge tool to apply heat,
pressure, or a combination thereof to the flooring edge finish.

138

Optionally, apply more heat, pressure, or a combination thereof to the flooring
edge finish with heat gun.

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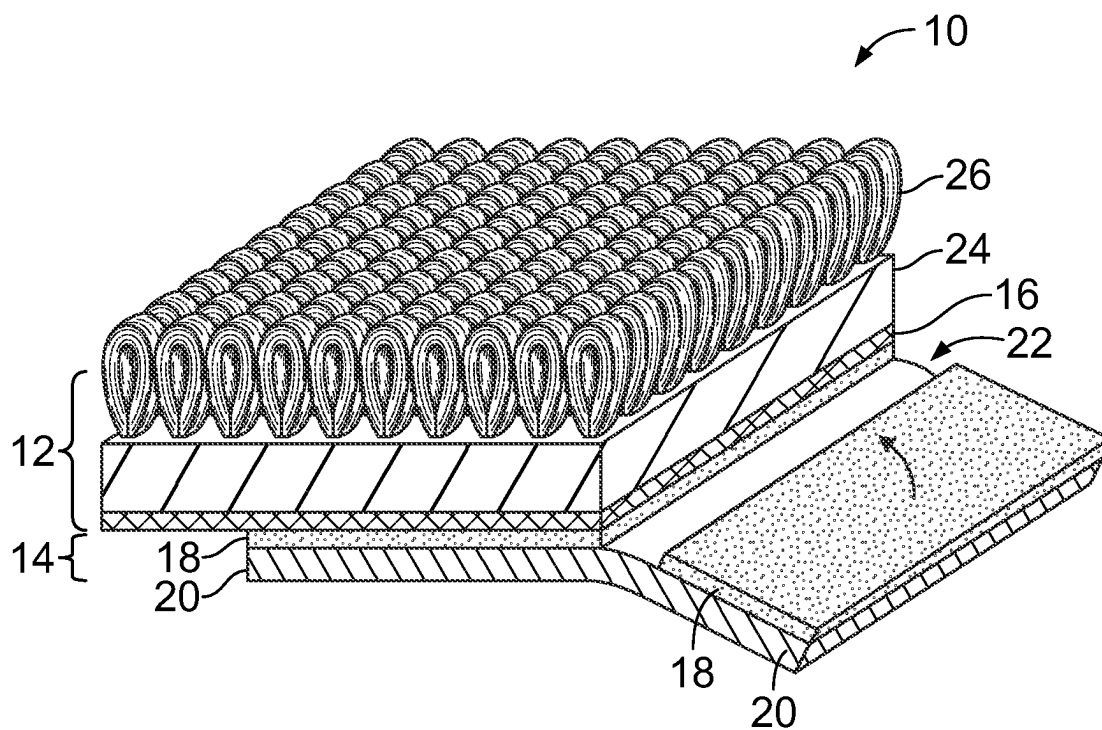


FIG. 1

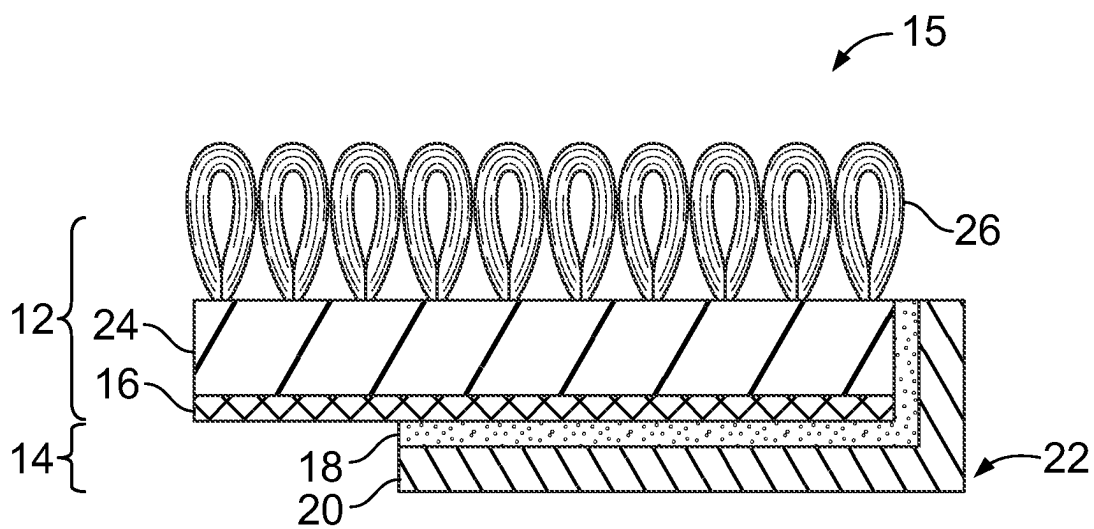


FIG. 2

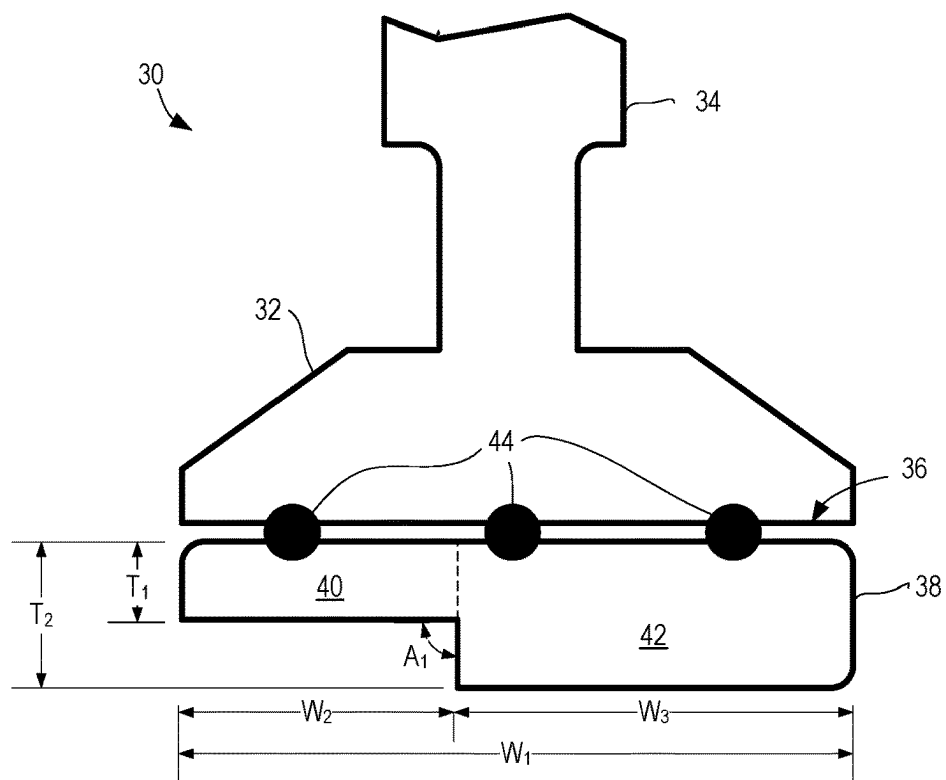


FIG. 3

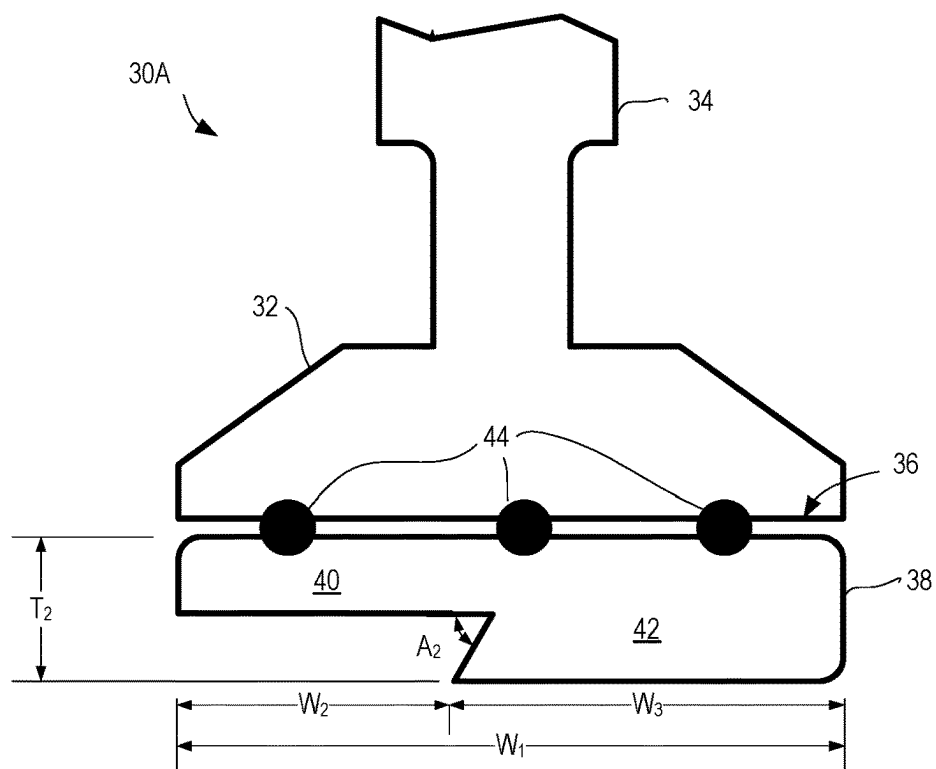


FIG. 4

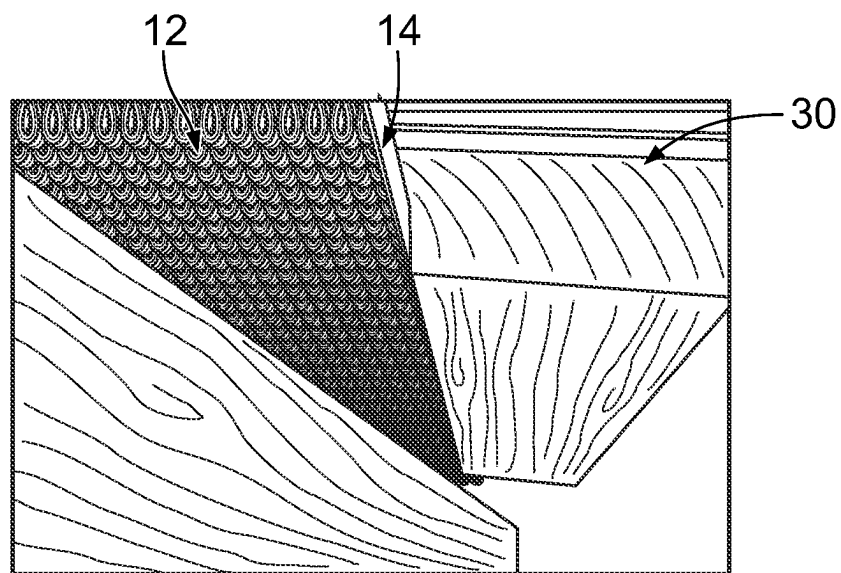


FIG. 5

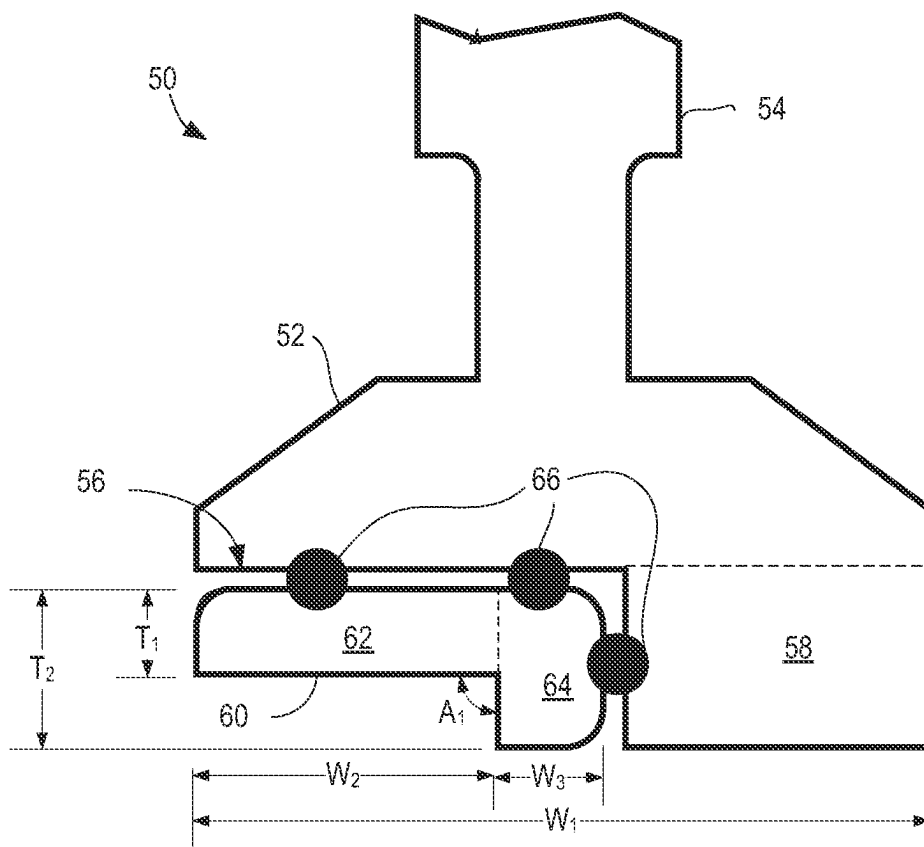


FIG. 6

70 

72

Position a flooring edge finish along a bottom and/or an edge of a flooring.

74

Use a flooring edge tool to apply heat, pressure, or a combination thereof to the flooring edge finish to adhere to the flooring.

76

Optionally, apply more heat, pressure, or a combination thereof to the flooring edge finish with heat gun.

FIG. 7

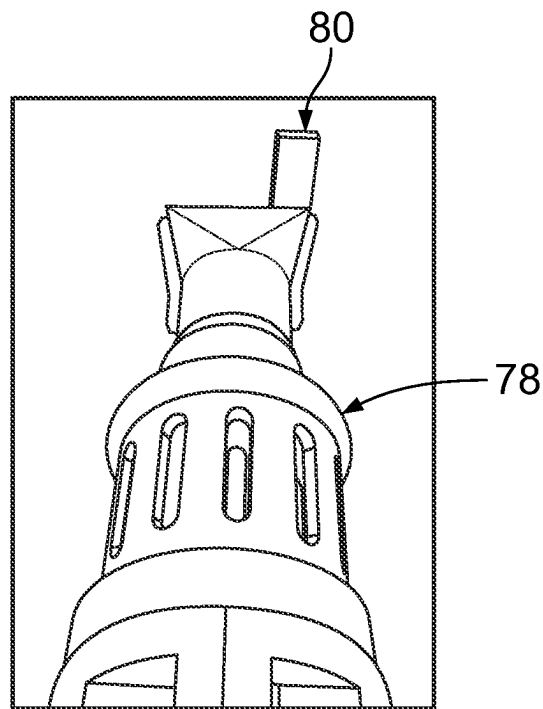


FIG. 8

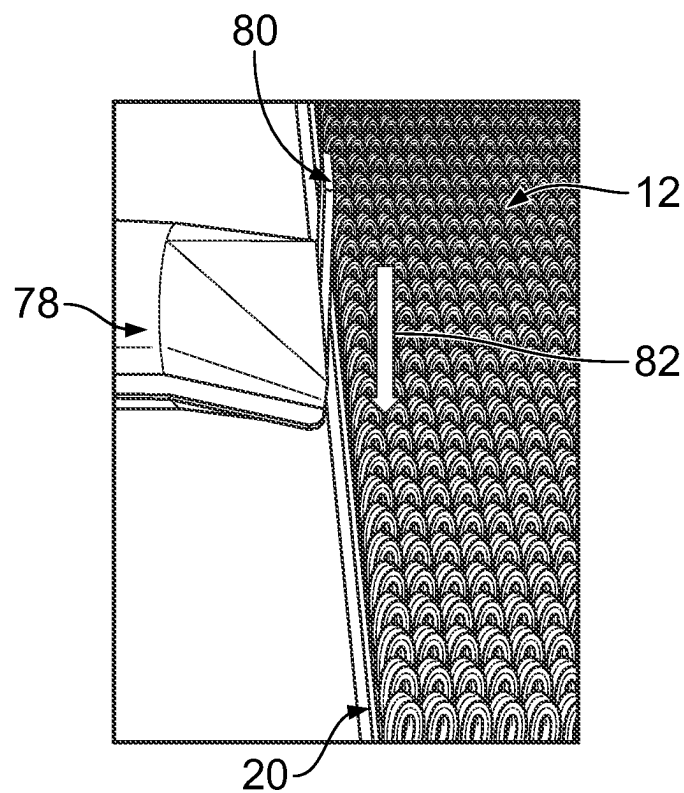


FIG. 9

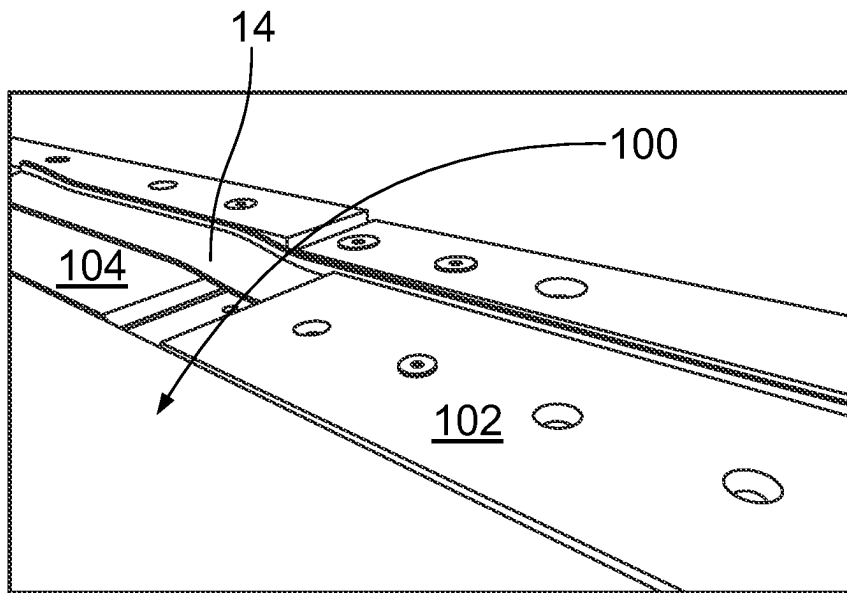


FIG. 10

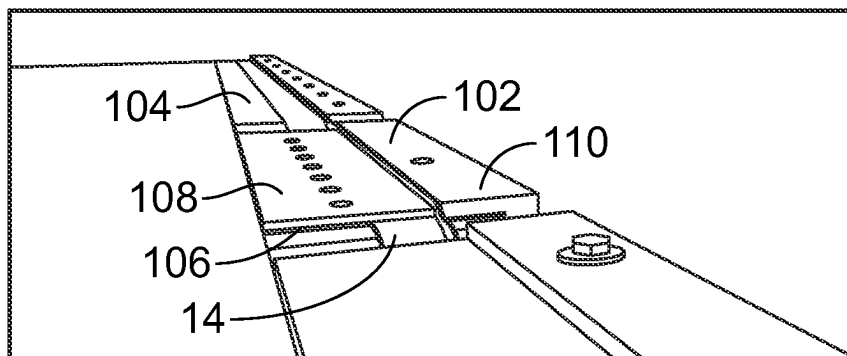


FIG. 11

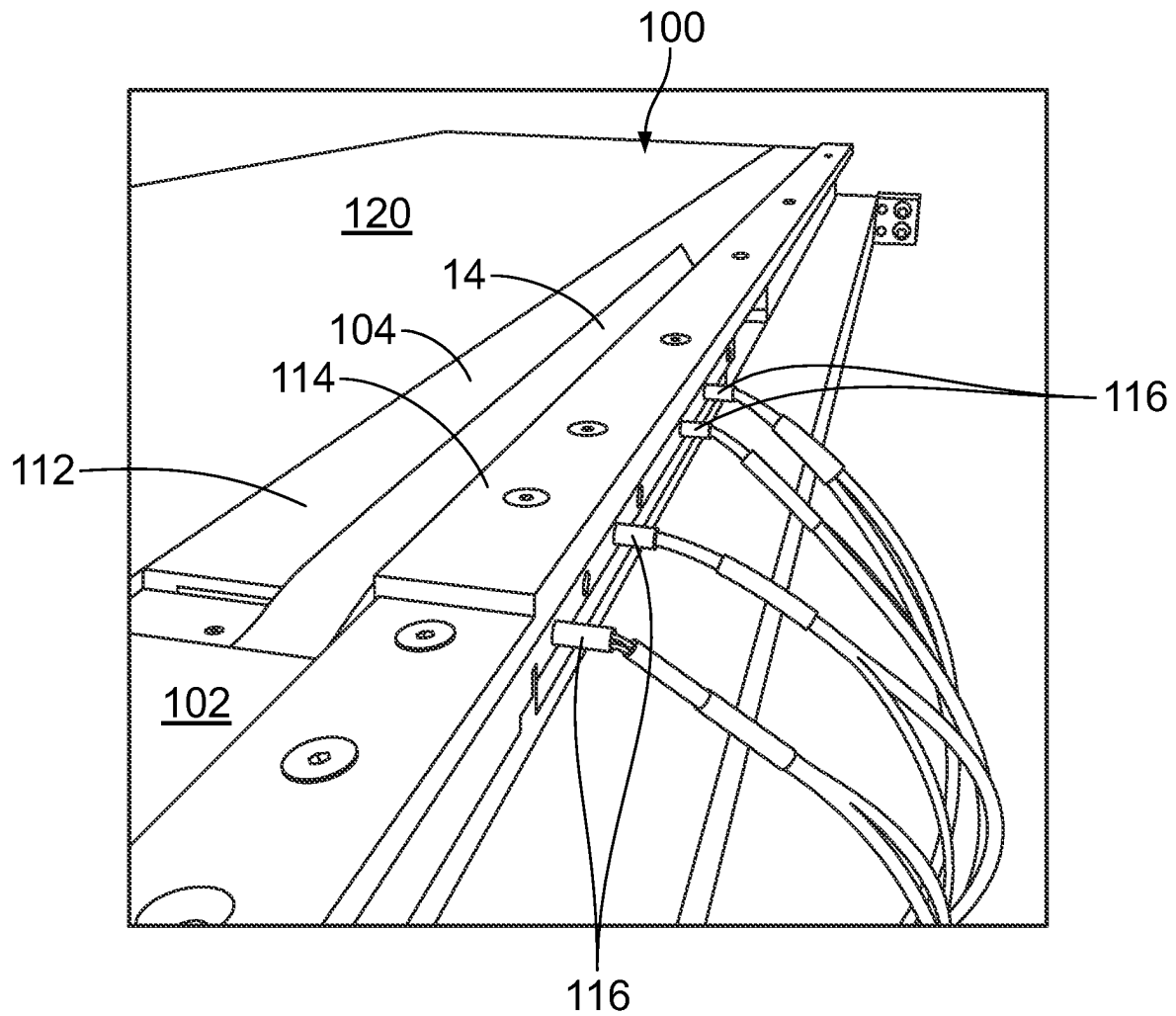


FIG. 12

130



132

Feed a flooring edge finish into a feed section of a table-mounted flooring edge tool.

134

Feed the flooring along the feed section.

136

Use an attachment section of a table-mounted flooring edge tool to apply heat, pressure, or a combination thereof to the flooring edge finish.

138

Optionally, apply more heat, pressure, or a combination thereof to the flooring edge finish with heat gun.

FIG. 13

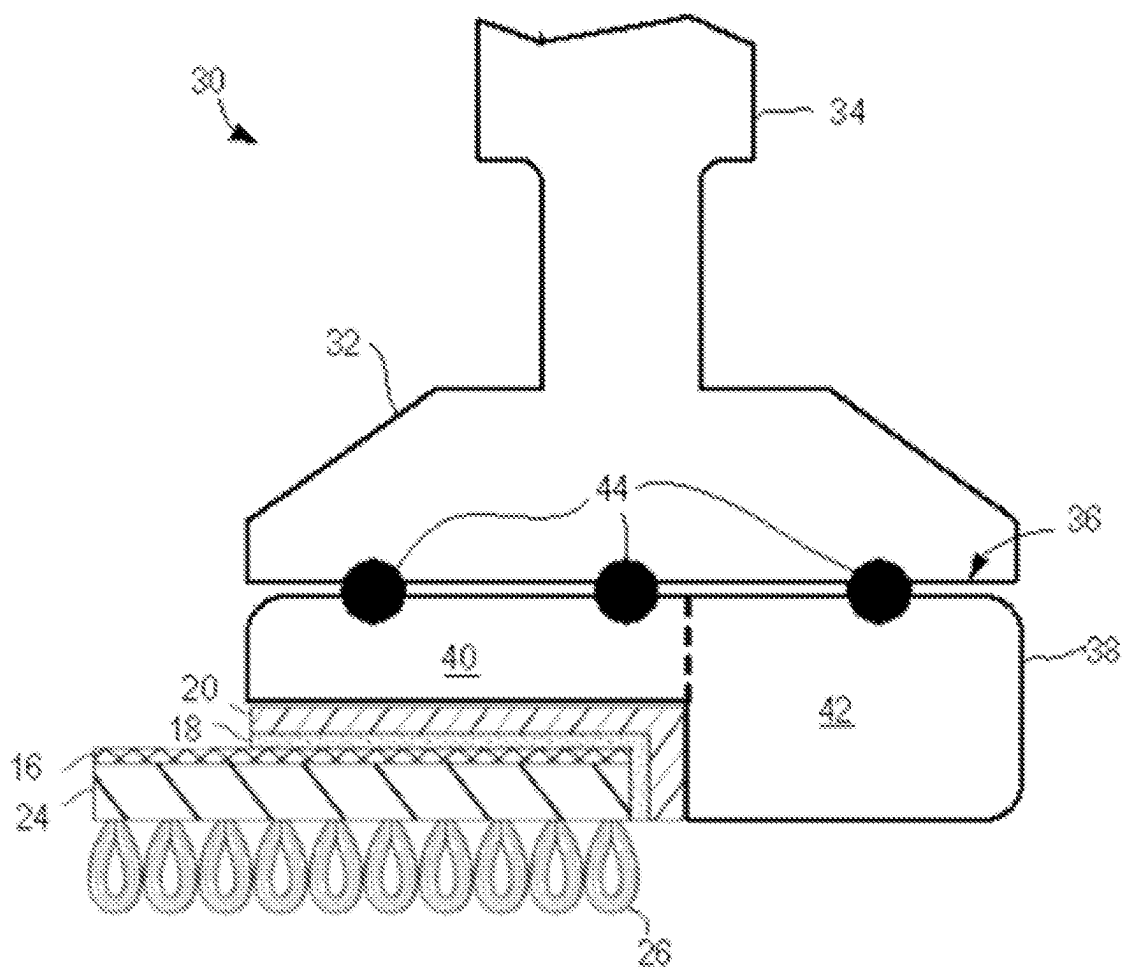


FIG. 14

FLOORING EDGE TOOLS**CROSS REFERENCE TO RELATED APPLICATIONS**

This application is a divisional application, which claims priority to pending U.S. patent application Ser. No. 17/320,777 filed on May 14, 2021, which claims the benefit of priority U.S. Provisional Patent Application No. 63/025,675, filed on May 15, 2020. The entire contents of the above-referenced patent applications are incorporated by reference in their entirety herein.

BACKGROUND

Carpeting and hard surface flooring can function as beautiful additions to any home or business. The durability and esthetics of the finishing of many of these products need improvement, however. Generally, carpets that are not fitted to a wall have an exposed edge that should be bound to prevent fraying of the carpet fibers and to prevent damage to the carpet backing underneath. Similarly, hard surface flooring can have a ragged and uneven edge, which can be damaged with wear.

Current methods of finishing flooring edges are ineffectual, often resulting in unattractive products. One method of preventing flooring edge fraying involves stapling the raw edge of the flooring with large metal staples, which is both unsightly and hazardous, as the staples inevitably detach with wear. Another method involves stitching the end of a carpet with heavy yarn, which stitching is inelegant and unravels with time. Furthermore, stitching requires expensive, heavy-duty sewing machines. Still another method pertains to gluing the edge of the flooring, which application and outcome is messy and displeasing to the eye. In addition, these methods can be troublesome because bulky, heavy equipment must be used for the installation and flooring edge finishing. Thus, there exists a need for a compact, easy-to-use, hand-held tool for finishing the edge of a carpet or hard surface flooring at an installation site and for an in-line system for finishing an edge in a factory setting, which the present disclosure provides.

BRIEF SUMMARY

The present application is directed to a hand-held or table-mounted flooring edge tool for applying a flooring edge finish, which provides the look of a factory or custom finish to the edge of a carpet or a hard surface flooring. Upon installation, the raw edge of the flooring is securely and discreetly hidden by the flooring edge finish. The flooring edge finish includes a longitudinal section coated with an adhesive and a hinge. The flooring edge tool is structured so as to be able to apply heat, pressure, or a combination thereof, to the bottom and side sections of the flooring edge finish simultaneously.

The flooring edge tool for applying a flooring edge finish to a flooring surface includes a main body having a handle for grasping that includes a base having a first width W_1 ; a bi-level soleplate coplanar with and coupled to the base, the bi-level soleplate comprising at least two sections, wherein a first section of the soleplate has a first thickness T_1 , a length L , and a second width W_2 ; and a second section of the soleplate has a second thickness T_2 , the length L , and a third width W_3 , wherein T_2 is greater than T_1 , and W_3 is approximately equal to $W_1 - W_2$; and a heating element within the main body for heating the bi-level soleplate.

Another embodiment is directed to a method of applying a flooring edge finish to flooring using a flooring edge tool, which includes positioning a flooring edge finish at the edge of a flooring; and applying heat, pressure or a combination thereof to the flooring edge finish using the flooring edge tool having a bi-level soleplate, wherein the flooring edge finish is adhered to a bottom surface of the flooring and an edge of the flooring simultaneously.

Yet another embodiment is a heating table for applying and adhering a flooring edge finish to flooring, said table comprising a feed section including a first lower plate having a length and width; an upper plate positioned along both the length of the first lower plate and a portion of the width; and a first edge plate positioned along the length of the first lower plate and adjacent to the upper plate, wherein the upper plate and the first edge plate are separated by a gap; wherein the flooring edge finish is folded while moving through the feed section, such that a first longitudinal section of the finishing strip is positioned between the first lower and upper plates, and a second longitudinal section of the finishing strip is positioned between the upper plate and the first edge plate; and an attachment section abutting the feed section comprising a second lower plate; a second edge plate; and one or more heating elements for heating the second lower plate and the second edge plate to adhere the flooring edge finish to the bottom and edge surfaces of the flooring simultaneously.

Still another embodiment pertains to a method of applying a flooring edge finish to flooring using a table-mounted flooring edge tool comprising a feed section and an attachment section, the method comprising feeding a flooring edge finish into the feed section so that the flooring edge finish contacts the edge, bottom, or both edge and bottom of the flooring; feeding the flooring along the feed section so that a bottom and side of the flooring is adjacent to the flooring edge finish when leaving the feed section and entering the attachment section; and applying heat, pressure, or a combination thereof to the flooring edge finish using a heating element coupled to the attachment section, wherein the flooring edge finish is adhered to a bottom surface of the flooring and an edge of the flooring simultaneously.

The flooring edge finishing tool of this application has several benefits and advantages. One benefit is that the hand-held tool provides an uncomplicated and efficient method of on-site flooring edge finishing. A second benefit is that the hand-held tool is lightweight and compact making it easy to handle and to transport. A third benefit is the ability to simultaneously adhere a finishing strip to two surfaces (bottom and side) of a flooring edge with the unique biplanar soleplate. A fourth benefit is that the heating table can finish the flooring edge with a flooring edge finish as an in-line automated process.

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE DRAWINGS

FIG. 1 is a perspective view of a portion of a carpet and a flooring edge finish before adhesion of the flooring edge finish to the carpet's raw edge.

FIG. 2 is a side view of a portion of the carpet and flooring edge finish after adhesion of the flooring edge finish to the carpet's raw edge.

FIG. 3 is an end view of a hand-held flooring edge tool.

FIG. 4 is an end view of an alternative hand-held flooring edge tool.

FIG. 5 is a photograph illustrating the hand-held flooring tool of FIG. 3 as it is used to apply a flooring edge finish to a carpet.

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FIG. 6 is an end view of another hand-held flooring edge tool.

FIG. 7 is a flowchart illustrating a method of applying a flooring edge finish to flooring using a hand-held flooring edge tool.

FIG. 8 is a photograph of a heat gun for use in applying a flooring edge finish to a flooring.

FIG. 9 is a photograph of a heat gun in use.

FIG. 10 is a photograph of a side view of a table-mounted flooring edge tool.

FIG. 11 is a photograph of a side view of a table-mounted flooring edge tool.

FIG. 12 is a photograph of a side view of a table-mounted flooring edge tool.

FIG. 13 is a flowchart illustrating a method of applying a flooring edge finish to flooring using a table-mounted flooring edge tool.

FIG. 14 is an end view of a hand-held flooring edge tool adjacent to a carpet and flooring edge finish after adhesion of the flooring edge finish to the carpet's raw edge.

DETAILED DESCRIPTION OF EXEMPLARY EMBODIMENTS

FIG. 1 shows an embodiment of an unbound assembly 10 of a carpet 12 and a flooring edge finish 14. Carpet 12 is depicted as a representative flooring; however, any type of flooring can be used, including a carpet, a hard surface flooring, a luxury vinyl tile, a resilient vinyl flooring, a laminate flooring, or a mixture thereof. Carpet 12 has fibers 26 embedded into carpet backing 24. Carpet pad 16, which is optional, can be included underneath carpet backing 24. Flooring edge finish 14 includes a longitudinal section 20 including a hinge 22. The longitudinal section 20 has an adhesive 18 on a top surface. Hinge 22 has a gap or an absence of the adhesive. Flooring edge finish 14 is upwardly foldable along the hinge 22 to bind, protect, and conceal an edge of a flooring as shown in FIG. 2. Although flooring edge finish 14 is shown in contact with pad 16, this is for purposes of illustrating a positioning of flooring edge finish 14 and does not indicate that the flooring edge finish has been partially adhered to carpet 12.

FIG. 2 shows a side view 15 of carpet 12 and flooring edge finish 14 after flooring edge finish 14 has been adhered to a carpet 12. As in FIG. 1, carpet 12 has fibers 26 embedded into carpet backing 24 and an optional carpet pad 16 underneath the carpet backing 24. Flooring edge finish 14 has been folded upward approximately 90 degrees along the hinge 22 so that the adhesive 18 on longitudinal section 20 contacts carpet pad 16 and carpet backing 24. Flooring edge finish 14 binds and covers the carpet 12 bottom surface and edge.

In one embodiment, hinge 22 can include an approximately 90-degree bend in the flooring edge finish 14 along a bottom section of the edge of the flooring after binding of the longitudinal section 20 to an edge of the flooring. Hinge 22 can also comprise a bend of about 20-170 degrees after binding to the flooring edge. Hinge 22 can also comprise multiple hinges or multiple gaps having little or no adhesive. Further, hinge 22 can form an arcuate bend.

Application of flooring edge finish 14 can be accomplished by heating longitudinal section 20 containing the adhesive 18 with flooring edge tool. The tool can be hand-held, or table-mounted. In one embodiment, the hand-held tool is used to heat the flooring edge finish 14 with pressure against the flooring to provide adherence of the flooring edge finish. In a continuous process where the flooring edge

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tool is table-mounted, the flooring edge finish 14 can be fed parallel to the flooring, which would properly position the longitudinal section 20 of the flooring edge finish alongside the bottom and side edges of the flooring. Once positioned, flooring edge finish 14 could be heated while traveling with the flooring through the machinery of the continuous process.

FIG. 3 is an end view of a hand-held flooring edge tool 30. A main body 32 of the tool includes an upper extension 34, which can incorporate a handle or grasping surface (not shown). Main body 32 also includes a base 36 having a first width W_1 of about 0.2-12 inches, and a length L of about 4-12 inches. In embodiments, length L would extend in a generally perpendicular direction from the end of base 36. A bi-level soleplate 38 is co-planar with and coupled to base 36. Bi-level soleplate 38 includes a first section 40 having a first thickness T_1 of about 0.1-1 inches, length L , and a second width W_2 of about 0.1-6 inches, wherein the second width W_2 is less than the first width W_1 . The second section of the soleplate 42 has a second thickness T_2 of about 0.2-6 inches, length L and a third width W_3 of about 0.1-6 inches, wherein T_2 is greater than T_1 and W_3 is approximately equal to $W_1 - W_2$. First section 40 and second section 42 meet to form an angle A_1 . In embodiments, angle A_1 is approximately 65-85 degrees. In another embodiment, angle A_1 is approximately 90 degrees.

One or more heating elements 44 are incorporated in main body 32 of the hand-held flooring edge tool in a position that brings them into contact with bi-level soleplate 38 for adhering a flooring edge finish 14 to flooring. Main body 32 also incorporates circuitry for controlling heating elements 44 and other components of hand-held flooring edge tool 30. While shown in mutual physical contact between the base 36 and bi-level soleplate 38, in an alternative embodiment, the heating elements 44 are embedded within the base 36 and are in thermal communication with the bi-level soleplate 38. The second lower plate and the second edge plate are capable of being heated to a temperature of approximately 200-500 degrees F. The flooring edge tool can adhere the flooring edge finish to the bottom and the edge of the flooring simultaneously.

FIG. 4 is an end view of hand-held flooring edge tool 30A. In embodiments, flooring edge tool 30A is generally the same as tool 30 in FIG. 3, except that angle A_2 between first section 40 and second section 42 is less than 90 degrees. In embodiments, angle A_2 can be between approximately 65 and 85 degrees. Angle A_2 can be used in flooring edge tool 30A to cause flooring edge finish 14 to be more firmly attached to the flooring.

FIG. 5 is a photograph illustrating an end view of hand-held flooring tool 30, as it is used to apply a flooring edge finish 14 to a carpet 12. Carpet 12 is placed upside down while flooring edge finish 14 is adhered to the bottom and side of carpet 12 simultaneously.

FIG. 6 is an end view of a hand-held flooring edge tool 50. A main body 52 includes an upper extension 54, which can incorporate a handle or grasping surface (not shown). Main body 52 of the tool also includes a base 56 having a width W_1 and a length L (not shown). In embodiments, length L would extend in a generally perpendicular direction from the end of base 56. Width W_1 includes base 56 as well as base projection 58, which extends downward from base 56 to a thickness approximately equal to T_2 . Base projection 58 extends downward from base 56 along the entire length L of base 56.

A bi-level soleplate 60 is coupled to base 56 and base projection 58. Bi-level soleplate 60 includes a first section

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62 having a first thickness T_1 , length L and a second width W_2 , wherein the second width W_2 is less than the first width W_1 and a second section **64** having a second thickness T_2 , length L and a third width W_3 , wherein T_2 is greater than T_1 and W_3 is approximately equal to $W_1 - W_2$. In another embodiment, the second width W_2 is greater than, less than, or equal to the third width W_3 . First section **62** and second section **64** form an angle A_1 . In embodiments, angle A_1 is approximately 90 degrees, but can be any angle between approximately 65 and 85 degrees. In another embodiment, a total width of the bi-level soleplate ($W_2 + W_3$) is less than the width of the base (W_1). The soleplate can be made of polymer, carbon, metal, ceramic, glass, or a mixture thereof.

Heating elements **66** are incorporated in main body **52** in a position that brings them into contact with bi-level soleplate **60** for heating a flooring edge finish **14** to flooring. Main body **52** also incorporates circuitry for controlling heating elements **66** and other components of hand-held flooring edge tool **30**. While shown in mutual physical contact between the base **56** and bi-level soleplate **60** of the tool, in an alternative embodiment, the heating elements **66** are embedded within the base **56** and are in thermal communication with the bi-level soleplate **60**. The heating elements **66** can be spread out randomly or uniformly within the main body **52**.

FIG. 7 is a flowchart illustrating a method **70** of applying a flooring edge finish to flooring using the edge finishing tool of FIG. 3, 4 or 6. In embodiments, method **70** includes at least one of steps **72**, **74** and **76**.

Step **72** includes positioning a flooring edge finish **14** of FIG. 1 along an edge of a flooring. In an example of step **72**, flooring edge finish has a longitudinal section including a hinge and the longitudinal section is positioned along a bottom surface of the flooring and along a side of the flooring.

Step **74** includes using a flooring edge tool to apply heat, pressure or a combination thereof to the flooring edge finish. In an example of step **74**, a bi-level soleplate **38** of flooring edge tool **30** is positioned against the longitudinal section to simultaneously adhere the flooring edge finish to the bottom and edge surfaces of the flooring simultaneously.

Step **76**, which is optional, includes using a heat gun or other external heat source to apply heat, pressure, or a combination thereof to the flooring edge finish so as to melt the adhesive and adhere to the flooring surfaces. In an example of step **76**, a heat gun **78** as shown in FIG. 8 includes a pressure plate **80**. As shown in FIG. 9, heat gun **78** optionally can be applied to longitudinal section **20** of flooring edge finish **14** in the direction of arrow **82** to heat longitudinal section **20**, then apply pressure using pressure plate **80**.

Yet another embodiment is a heating table for applying and adhering a flooring edge finish to flooring, said table comprising a feed section including a first lower plate having a length and width; an upper plate positioned along both the length of the first lower plate and a portion of the width; and a first edge plate positioned along the length of the first lower plate and adjacent to the upper plate, wherein the upper plate and the first edge plate are separated by a gap; wherein the flooring edge finish is folded while moving through the feed section such that a first longitudinal section of the finishing strip is positioned between the first lower and upper plates, and a second longitudinal section of the finishing strip is positioned between the upper plate and the first edge plate; and an attachment section abutting the feed section comprising a second lower plate; a second edge plate; and one or more heating elements for heating the

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second lower plate and the second edge plate to adhere the flooring edge finish to bottom and edge surfaces of flooring simultaneously. The second lower plate and the second edge plate comprise polymer, carbon, metal, ceramic, glass, or a mixture thereof. The first edge plate has a shorter length than the first lower plate.

FIGS. 10-12 are photographs of different perspectives of a table mounted flooring edge tool. In embodiments, the table-mounted flooring edge tool **100** includes a feed section **102** and an attachment section **104**. Feed section **102** includes a lower plate **106**, an upper plate **108** and an edge plate **110**. One longitudinal section of flooring edge finish **14** is sandwiched between lower plate **106** and the upper plate **108** while another longitudinal section is sandwiched between upper plate **108** and edge plate **110**. In embodiments, upper plate **108** can have the same length as lower plate **106**, or upper plate **108** can be shorter than lower plate **106** to assist movement of flooring edge finish **14** from feed section **102** to attachment section **104**. The configuration of lower plate **106**, upper plate **108** and edge plate **110** serves to bend flooring edge finish **14** along hinge **22**. Flooring edge finish **14** enters one end of feed section **102** as shown in FIG. 11, and exits the other end of feed section **102** as shown in FIG. 10 in preparation for being applied to a flooring.

In embodiments, table-mounted flooring edge tool **100** includes an attachment section **104**. Attachment section **104** generally abuts feed section **102** so that flooring can move smoothly in the process. In embodiments, attachment section **104** and feed section **102** are separated by a gap. Attachment section **104** includes a lower plate **112** and an edge plate **114**. Lower plate **112** is generally co-planar with upper plate **108**. Edge plate **114** is generally coplanar with edge plate **110**. In embodiments, edge plate **114** can be thicker than edge plate **110** to accommodate the combined thickness of flooring edge finish **14** and flooring.

Attachment section **104** includes one or more heating elements **116**, which can be used to heat lower plate **112** and edge plate **114** while applying flooring edge finish **14** to a flooring (not shown). Lower plate **112** and edge plate **114** can be fabricated of suitable rigid conductors of heat including, but not limited to, polymer, carbon, metal ceramic, glass, or mixtures thereof. The metal can be aluminum, copper, brass, steel, or bronze. The heat conductors are capable of being heated to a temperature of approximately 200-500 degrees F. The heating temperature can vary or can be constant. In embodiments, edge plate **114** can form an angle of approximately 90 degrees with lower plate **112**. In other embodiments, edge plate **114** can form an angle between approximately 65 and 85 degrees with lower plate **112**.

In embodiments, table-mounted flooring edge tool **100** can include a support section **120** for supporting a flooring while flooring edge finish **14** is being applied. In embodiments, edge plates **110** and **114** can have a thickness of approximately 0.1 to 1 inch. In embodiments, feed section **102** and attachment section **104** can have a length of approximately 6 inches up to entire length of flooring material edge.

FIG. 13 is a flowchart illustrating a method **130** of applying a flooring edge finish to flooring using the table-mounted flooring edge tool of FIGS. 10-12. In embodiments, method **130** includes at least one of steps **132**, **134**, **136** and **138**, described below.

FIG. 14 shows a view of the hand-held flooring tool **30** adjacent to an applied finishing strip **14** on an edge of a carpet **12**. Shown is a side view **15** of carpet **12** and flooring

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edge finish **14** after flooring edge finish **14** has been adhered to a carpet **12**. As in FIG. 1, carpet **12** has fibers **26** embedded into carpet backing **24** and an optional carpet pad **16** underneath the carpet backing **24**. Flooring edge finish **14** has been folded upward approximately 90 degrees along the hinge **22** so that the adhesive **18** on longitudinal section **20** contacts carpet pad **16** and carpet backing **24**. Flooring edge finish **14** binds and covers the carpet **12**.

Also shown is an end view of a hand-held flooring edge tool **30**. A main body **32** includes an upper extension **34**, which can incorporate a handle or grasping surface (not shown). Main body **32** also includes a base **36** having a width W_1 and a length L (not shown). In embodiments, length L would extend in a generally perpendicular direction from the end of base **36**. A bi-level soleplate **38** is co-planar with and coupled to base **36**. Bi-level soleplate **38** includes a first section **40** having a first thickness T_1 , length L and a second width W_2 , wherein the second width W_2 is less than the first width W_1 . The bi-level soleplate includes a second section **42** having a second thickness T_2 , length L and a third width W_3 , wherein T_2 is greater than T_1 and W_3 is approximately equal to $W_1 - W_2$. In another embodiment, the length L is greater than or equal to the width of the base W_1 . First section **40** and second section **42** form an angle A_1 . In embodiments, angle A_1 is approximately 65-95 degrees or, in another embodiment, about 90 degrees.

One or more heating elements **44** are incorporated in main body **32** in a position that brings them into contact with bi-level soleplate **38** for heating during application of a flooring edge finish **14** to flooring. Main body **32** also incorporates circuitry for controlling heating elements **44** and other components of hand-held flooring edge tool **30**. While shown in mutual physical contact between the base **36** and bi-level soleplate **38**, in an alternative embodiment, the heating elements **44** are embedded within the base **36** and are in thermal communication with the bi-level soleplate **38**. The heating elements can be randomly or uniformly positioned.

Step **132** includes feeding a flooring edge finish **14** of FIG. 1 into feed section **102**. In an example of step **132**, flooring edge finish includes a longitudinal section including a hinge where the longitudinal section is placed along a bottom surface of the flooring and the other longitudinal section is placed along a side of the flooring. One longitudinal section is fed between lower plate **106** and upper plate **108** while the other longitudinal section is fed between upper plate **108** and edge plate **110**.

Step **134** includes feeding a flooring along feed section **102**. In an example of step **134**, flooring travels along feed section **102** at the same rate that flooring edge finish **14** so that a leading edge of the flooring and flooring edge finish **14** meet as they leave feed section **102** and enter attachment section **104**. Feed section **102** causes flooring edge finish **14** to be positioned along a bottom and edge of the flooring so that the flooring edge finish can be adhered to the flooring in attachment section **104**.

Step **136** includes using attachment section **104** to apply heat, pressure or a combination thereof to the flooring edge finish. In an example of step **136**, attachment section **104** is placed against both longitudinal sections simultaneously to adhere flooring edge finish **14** to the bottom and side surfaces of the flooring simultaneously.

Step **138**, which is optional, includes using a heat gun to apply heat, pressure or a combination thereof to the flooring edge finish. In embodiments, step **138** is similar to step **76** of FIG. 7.

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Alternative embodiments of the subject matter of this application will become apparent to one of ordinary skill in the art to which the present invention pertains, without departing from its spirit and scope. It is to be understood that no limitation with respect to specific embodiments shown here is intended or inferred.

We claim:

1. A heating table for applying and adhering a flooring edge finish to flooring, said table comprising:

(a) a feed section comprising:

- (i) a first lower plate having a length and width;
- (ii) an upper plate positioned along both the length of the first lower plate and a portion of the width; and
- (iii) a first edge plate positioned along the length of the first lower plate and adjacent to the upper plate, wherein the upper plate and the first edge plate are separated by a gap;

wherein the flooring edge finish is folded while moving through the feed section, such that a first longitudinal section of the flooring edge finish is positioned between the first lower and upper plates, and a second longitudinal section of the flooring edge finish is positioned between the upper plate and the first edge plate; and

(b) an attachment section abutting the feed section, comprising:

- (i) a second lower plate;
- (ii) a second edge plate; and
- (iii) one or more heating elements for heating the second lower plate and the second edge plate to apply the flooring edge finish to a bottom surface and an edge surface of the flooring.

2. The heating table of claim 1, wherein the first edge plate has a shorter length than the first lower plate.

3. The heating table of claim 1, wherein the second lower plate and the second edge plate comprise polymer, carbon, metal, ceramic, glass, or a mixture thereof.

4. The heating table of claim 1, wherein the second lower plate and the second edge plate are capable of being heated to a temperature of approximately 200-500 degrees F.

5. The heating table of claim 1, wherein the second lower plate and the second edge plate have a length of approximately 6 inches up to entire length of flooring material edge.

6. The heating table of claim 1, wherein the first and second edge plates have a thickness of approximately 0.1 to 1 inch.

7. The heating table of claim 1, further comprising a support section.

8. The heating table of claim 1, wherein the heating table is capable of finishing the flooring edge with a flooring edge finish as an in-line automated process.

9. A heating table for applying and adhering a flooring edge finish to flooring, said table comprising:

(a) a feed section comprising:

- (i) a first lower plate having a length and width;
- (ii) an upper plate positioned along both the length of the first lower plate and a portion of the width; and
- (iii) a first edge plate positioned along the length of the first lower plate and adjacent to the upper plate, wherein the upper plate and the first edge plate are separated by a gap; and

(b) an attachment section comprising:

- (i) a second lower plate;
- (ii) a second edge plate; and
- (iii) one or more heating elements;

wherein the feed section and the attachment section are separated by a gap.

10. The heating table of claim 9, wherein the second lower plate and the second edge plate comprise polymer, carbon, metal, ceramic, glass, or a mixture thereof.

11. The heating table of claim 9, wherein the second lower plate and the second edge plate are capable of being heated 5 to a temperature of approximately 200-500 degrees F.

12. The heating table of claim 9, wherein the second lower plate and the second edge plate have a length of approximately 6 inches up to entire length of flooring material edge.

13. The heating table of claim 9, wherein the first and 10 second edge plates have a thickness of approximately 0.1 to 1 inch.

14. The heating table of claim 9, wherein the lower plate is co-planar with the upper plate.

15. The heating table of claim 9, wherein the first and 15 second edge plates are co-planar.

16. The heating table of claim 9, wherein the first and second edge plates have different thicknesses.

17. The heating table of claim 9, wherein the first and 20 second edge plates have identical thicknesses.

18. The heating table of claim 9, wherein the second lower plate and the second edge plate can form an angle of approximately 90 degrees.

19. The heating table of claim 9, wherein the second lower plate and the second edge plate can form an angle in the 25 range of about 65 to about 85 degrees.

20. The heating table of claim 9, further comprising a support section.

21. The heating table of claim 9, wherein the heating table is capable of finishing the flooring edge with a flooring edge 30 finish as an in-line automated process.

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